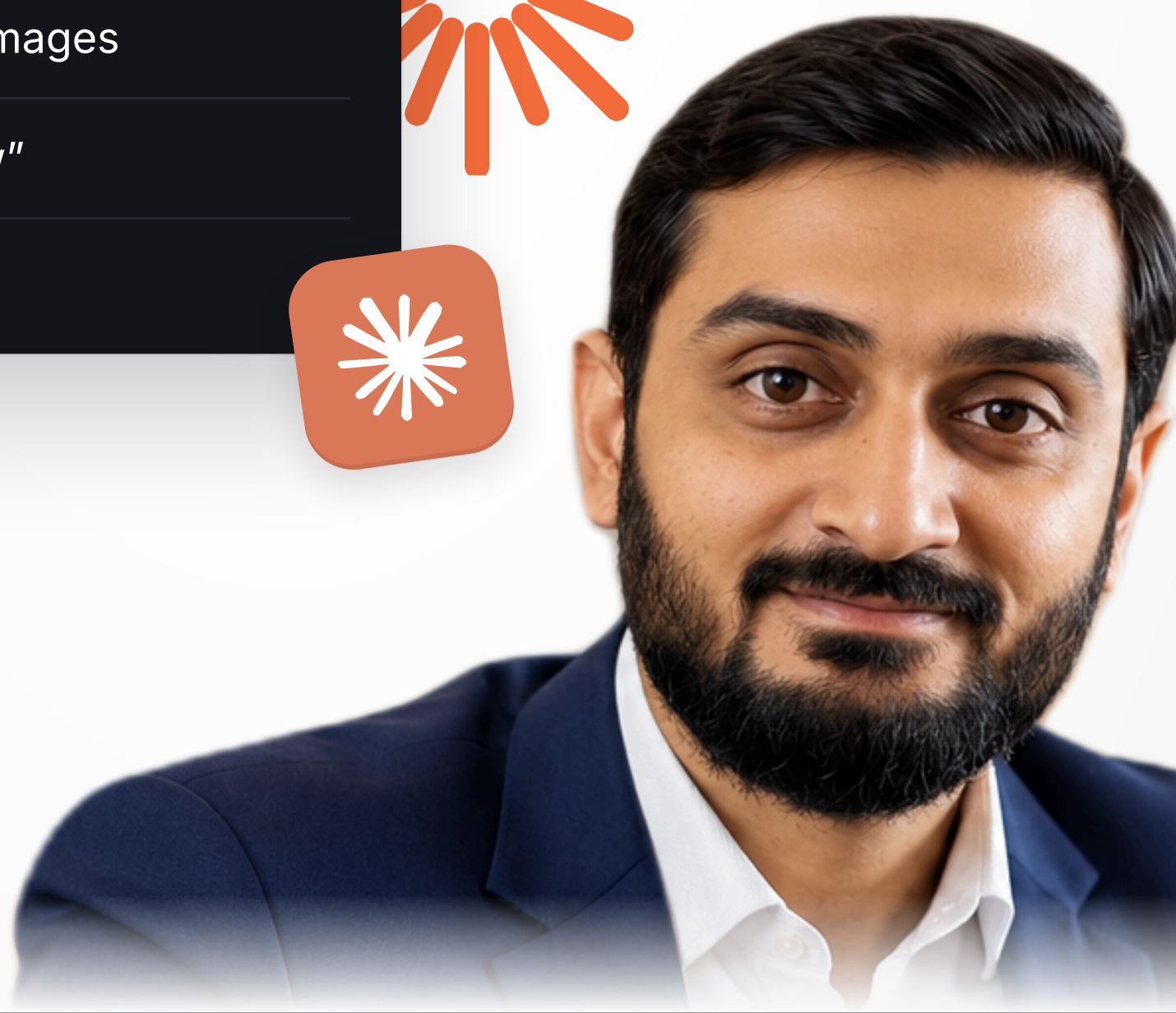
I Don't Pick the Model First

(I pick the task)

Model checklist

- ✓ Follows long instructions
- ✓ Clean structured output
- ✓ Reads PDFs and images
- ✓ Says "I don't know"
- ✓ Cost for this task



Swipe →

My Checks

What I Test for Each Task

1. **Follows long instructions without drifting**
2. **Returns clean structured output every time**
3. **Reads PDFs and images well**
4. **Says “I don’t know” instead of guessing**
5. **Costs what makes sense for this task**

Check 2

Clean Output, Every Time

The next step reads it. **One broken bracket** and the flow stops.

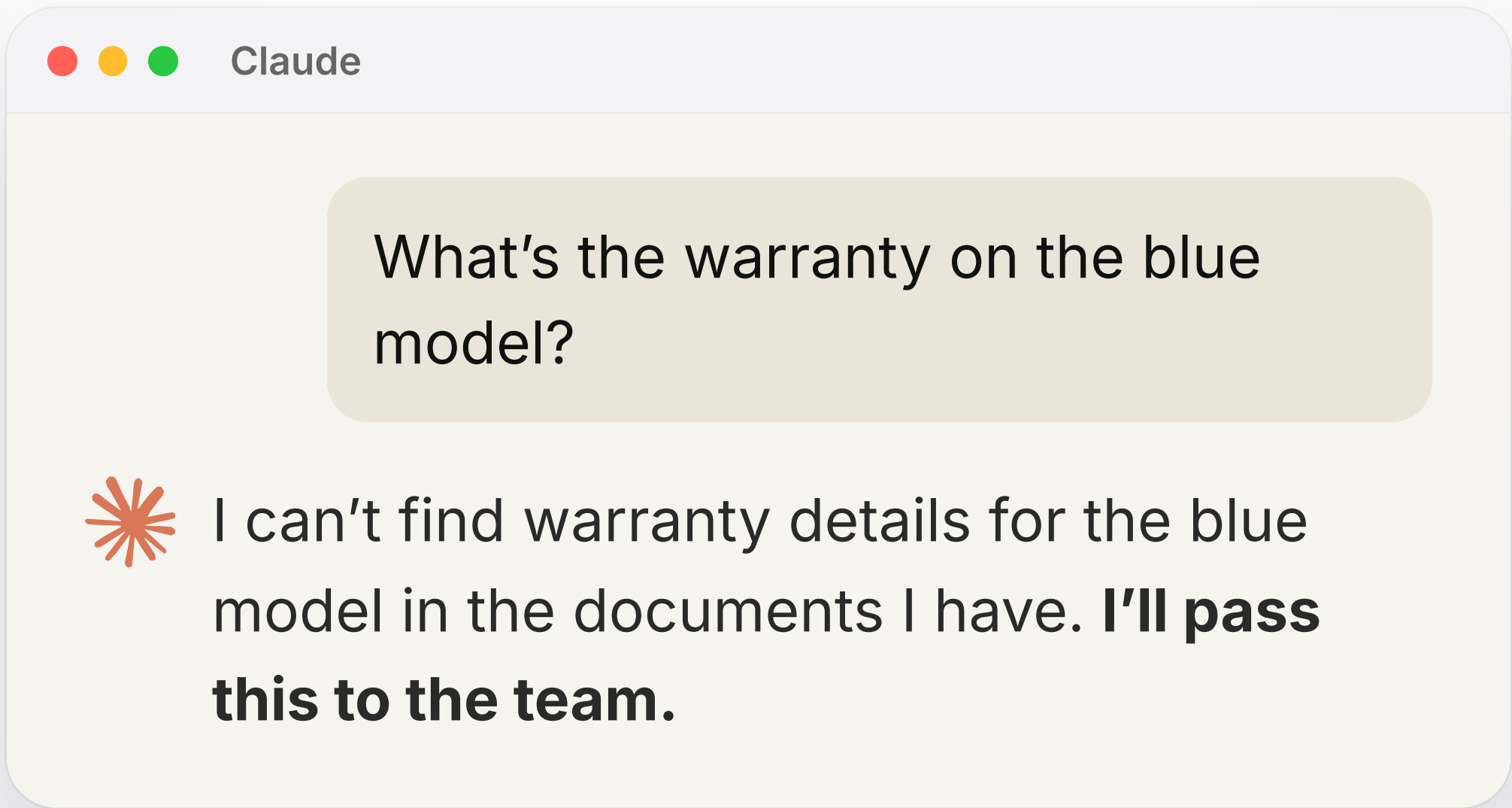
output.json

```
{
  "type": "order",
  "customer": "Rahul",
  "items": 2,
  "urgent": false
}
```

same shape, every single run

Check 4

“I Don’t Know” Beats a Guess



a confident guess is the expensive one

Swappable

One Model per Step, Easy to Change

In n8n, each step's model is **one setting**. Swap it when something cheaper works.

SUPPORT WORKFLOW

Sort enquiries	smaller model
Read PDF invoices	Claude
Draft replies	Claude

simple step? smaller, cheaper model

The Rule

The Best Model Is...

...the one that does your task reliably, at a cost that makes sense.

for most of my agents, that's Claude

Which model are you building with?

MT

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